

Gabit aims to kill health anxiety

With better data, says Founder and CEO, Gaurav Gupta

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The urban Indian has been only taught one way of living — through grind and that includes late nights, cross-country flights and endless streams of caffeine. Health was always an afterthought. But walk into any corporate office or neighborhood park today and the conversations have radically shifted. People are proactively discussing active course, circadian rhythms, running clubs and active lifestyle.

As India becomes hyper-conscious of its fitness, a paradox has emerged. The tools that help us navigate this lifestyle have often made it more complex.

For years, tracking health meant strapping bulky bands to wrists, navigating labyrinthine mobile apps and trying to make sense of disparate metrics that refused to speak to one another. This is where smart rings, a category I was apprehensive about, is making a huge wave. And, joining the revolution is the Indian startup Gabit.

As a co-founder of Zomato, Gaurav Gupta spent years fueling India's late-night food cravings and navigating the high-stress, low-sleep landscape of a tech unicorn. Today, he is on a dia-

metrically opposite mission: teaching Indians how to build sustainable, long-term health habits. Gabit is a home-grown health tech ecosystem centered around a sleek, data-rich smart ring.

Zomato to "Good Habits"

Gupta's pivot to health came during the isolation of the COVID-19 pandemic. The unfortunate turn of events forced a reset button on him.

"During COVID, for the first time in life, travel stopped for me,"

Gupta recalls. "I fell into a good rhythm of just working out regularly, eating better food, and sleeping at home and not flights. My health improved."

The results were stark: Gupta lost 15 kilograms of weight and his metabolic age plummeted by 14 years. The transformation felt magical, sparking a realisation that his next professional chapter had to focus on an area of greater human impact than food delivery. Following Zomato's IPO, he stepped away to immerse himself in the science of wellness.

His research led to the realisation that any health objective whether managing diabetes, combating obesity

or reversing hypertension rests on four fundamental pillars: fitness, nutrition, sleep and stress.

"The beautiful part is they're all interconnected. They feed off each other. You sleep well, you do fitness better. You do fitness better, you eat better," Gupta explained.

However, building good habits is inherently painful because the biological reward system is delayed. Bad habits offer an instant dopamine kick, while positive lifestyle choices take weeks or months to manifest visible results. To bridge that gap, continuous feedback is essential. "You can't improve something that you can't measure," Gupta says.

Thus, the concept of Gabit — a portmanteau of "good habit" — was born, built entirely on the thesis that frictionless tracking is the ultimate catalyst for behavioral change.

Debunking the weekend sleep myth

As Gabit accumulated data over its first two years, Gupta's team began uncovering something fascinating, counter-intuitive insights into the true state of Indian health. The most glaring revelation was centered entirely around sleep. In urban India, sleep deprivation has long been wore as a badge of honor. When asked about their rest, most professionals claim they sleep "fine," pointing to a standard six or six-and-a-half hours.

But Gupta stresses that absolute numbers tell only half of the story. The real blind spot lies in sleep architecture: the quality and duration of deep sleep, light sleep, and REM (Rapid Eye Movement) stages. While deep sleep governs most of the physical recovery, REM sleep regulates emotional balance and mental acuity. **d**



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